HACK876 × MICROSOFT

PRIVATE PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Pour into the students, one build at a time.

Microsoft already invests in young Jamaicans who want to build with technology. Hack876 is one day where high-school students get to do exactly that, with Microsoft people in the room.

Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)



80	9	1
STUDENTS	SCHOOL NETWORK	DAY

One day to build something that should exist.

Meet Hack876.



Hack876 is a one-day build competition for approximately **80 secondary-school students** from 5th Form through Upper 6th Form, working in teams of 3 to 4, roughly 20 teams in all, on Saturday, February 20, 2027 (tentative).

Teams pick a real problem, use modern tools including AI, get guidance from mentors, and finish the day with a working prototype and a pitch to judges. It is not a school assignment and there is no answer key.

Our **9-school network** in Kingston is made up of the schools where the Hack876 team currently has relationships and can coordinate most reliably. It is not an exclusive eligibility list.

BUILD SOMETHING THAT SHOULD EXIST.

Young Jamaicans, real skills, real builds.

Hack876 reaches students a few years before university, and a Microsoft award would tell them their first build counts.

MICROSOFT, ABOUT

> **"Microsoft's mission is to empower every person and every organization on the planet to achieve more."**[2]

Microsoft piloted Project Blue Mountain in 2024 to help make Jamaica the premier hub for STEAM talent development in the Caribbean, reaching secondary and tertiary institutions.[3]

Shane Patterson on leading it: "Coming back home and being able to pour into the students the way I would've wanted for myself is priceless."[4]

Tech Wave 2025 was set to open to high-school students for the first time, alongside university teams, with more than 30 teams mentored by technical experts.[4]

In 2021 Microsoft Jamaica and the Ministry of Education agreed a five-year plan to train 155,000 Jamaicans in digital skills, with a focus on young audiences.[5]

Through Microsoft Elevate, Microsoft has pledged more than $4 billion in cash and AI and cloud technology to K-12 schools, colleges and nonprofits over five years.[6]

Five years of building talent at home.

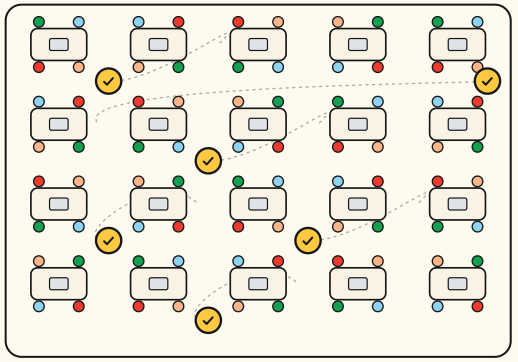
2021 — **A national skills agreement.**
Microsoft Jamaica and the Ministry of Education sign a five-year agreement to train 155,000 Jamaicans in digital skills.[5]

2022 — **Microsoft Day begins.**
Microsoft Day starts at the University of Technology, Jamaica.[7]

2024 — **Project Blue Mountain is piloted.**
Launched at the third Microsoft Day. Student teams pitch solutions to sustainable-development challenges in the PBM Hackathon finale.[3]

2025 — **AI reaches Grades 8 to 11.**
A week-long AI and entrepreneurship bootcamp at UWI Mona, run with AIM Educational Services in collaboration with Project Blue Mountain.[8]

2025 — **High schoolers invited in.**
Tech Wave, powered by Microsoft, expands to include high-school students, with a three-place cash podium for the hackathon.[4]



Microsoft keeps reaching younger students in Jamaica. Hack876 is a natural next step: a build day for fifth and sixth formers.

04 THE SCHOOL NETWORK

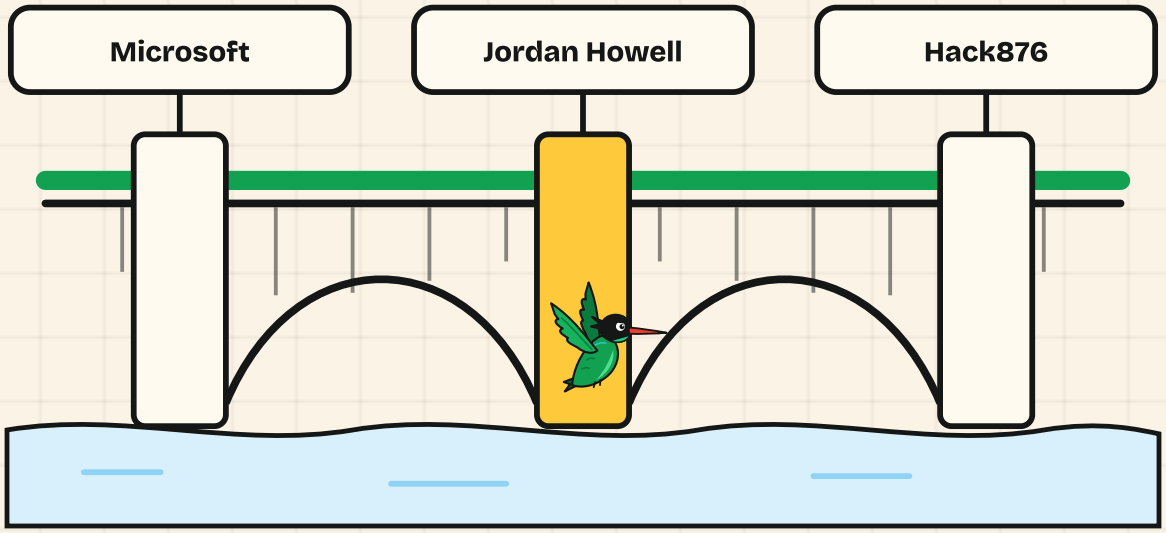
9 schools. One room.

Our judge Jordan Howell, who works at Microsoft, is a Campion College alumnus. Campion has confirmed its participation in Hack876.

Hack876 begins with the schools where we already have relationships and can coordinate most reliably for the inaugural staging. Formal confirmations are still in progress, and the network is not an exclusive eligibility list.

- Hillel Academy
- Campion College
- Jamaica College
- Immaculate Conception High School
- Wolmer's
- Ardenne High School
- American International School of Kingston
- St. Andrew High School for Girls
- St. George's College

Partnerships work better when someone carries the context.



Jordan is a confirmed Hack876 judge who works at Microsoft.

Jordan is also a Campion College alumnus, one of the schools in our network.

If open to it, Jordan could be a friendly first point of contact on the Microsoft side.

Because Jordan judges, any Microsoft-funded award would be decided by a judge who does not work at Microsoft.

THE BRIDGE

Jordan Howell

Hack876 judge · Microsoft

An invitation, not an obligation.

There are two natural homes for this inside Microsoft.

PRIZE

Support for the prizes

- Contribute toward the prizes, or a proposed Microsoft award
- Presented on stage by the Microsoft team
- Open to any tools, so the best build wins
- Decided by a judge who does not work at Microsoft

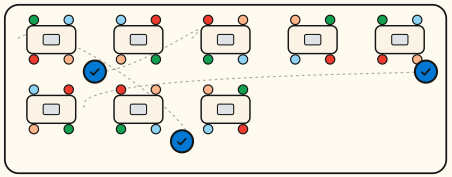
PEOPLE

Microsoft people in the room

- Three to five mentors for AI, cloud and data
- A short talk on building a tech career from Jamaica
- Remote mentoring works too

Microsoft's contribution does not have to be purely financial.

PEOPLE IN THE ROOM.



01
Mentors

Engineers who help teams get unstuck, without building the project for them.

02
Award presenters

The Microsoft team presents its award on stage at the close.

03
Speaker

A short, honest talk on coming home to build and give back.

04
Workshop lead

A short AI fundamentals session before the day, open to every team.

05
Judge

Jordan already judges. Microsoft-funded awards go to a judge outside Microsoft.

GROUND RULES WE WILL HOLD OURSELVES TO

No marketing, product sign-ups or account creation pushed to students, before, during or after the day.

No collection of student contact details or data by sponsors. Photos and names only with school and parent consent.

A judge who does not work at Microsoft decides any Microsoft-funded award, and teams may use any tools they choose.

Become a Gold Partner of the inaugural Hack876.

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

GOLD PARTNER · INAUGURAL HACK876

Microsoft already funds student hackathon prizes in Jamaica. Contributing toward the Hack876 prizes extends that to students a few years younger.

Any amount within the level is welcome. It is a flexible contribution toward the event, with no naming rights attached.

PROPOSED RECOGNITION

Microsoft

Gold Partner · Inaugural Hack876

Closest Hack876 tracks: Resilience, Learn, Business, Life

CONTRIBUTION LEVELS. ANY AMOUNT WITHIN A LEVEL IS WELCOME.

Bronze Partner	Silver Partner	Gold Partner	Platinum Partner
J$50,000 to below J$200,000	J$200,000 to below J$500,000	SUGGESTED J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000	J$1,000,000+

In-kind & Community Support: devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and contributions below J$50,000.

09 CONTRIBUTION LEVELS

What each level receives.

Bronze Partner

J$50,000 to below J$200,000

- Recognition on the Hack876 website
- Included in the grouped sponsor thank-you
- Named in the post-event recap

Silver Partner

J$200,000 to below J$500,000

- Everything in Bronze
- Placement on event signage
- Acknowledgement in the opening and closing

Gold Partner

J$500,000 to below J$1,000,000

OUR SUGGESTION

- Everything in Silver
- More prominent placement
- A dedicated sponsor feature
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

Platinum Partner

J$1,000,000+

- The most prominent sponsor placement
- An agreed opportunity to take part in the programme
- Logo on event shirts, if shirts are produced*

These are proposed benefits, to be agreed when a sponsorship is confirmed. A sponsor can contribute any amount within a band.

*Shirt placement applies only if event shirts are produced and artwork arrives before the production deadline.

Speaking, mentoring, presenting an award and judging are subject to suitability and programme capacity. Sponsorship does not buy influence over judging, and no level carries naming rights.

No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

WHAT A CONTRIBUTION COULD SUPPORT

- **Prizes.** Contributes toward the prizes for the top teams.
- **Special awards.** Helps support an existing special award.
- **Programming.** Helps support mentoring, judging and the student programme.

A sponsor can support the event overall, or agree a specific use with the Hack876 team. No contribution has to cover a whole cost.

WAYS TO HELP WITH A PRIZE

The planned prizes are iPad per student (up to 4); AirPods Pro per student (up to 4); gift card per student (up to 4). Any of these helps:

- **Donating the item**
- **Donating some of the quantity needed**
- **Gift cards or store credit**
- **A discount on the purchase**
- **A monetary contribution toward buying it**

In-kind & Community Support

For devices, gift cards, meals, refreshments, supplies, connectivity, expertise, and for contributions below J$50,000.

A meaningful in-kind contribution can be recognized at an equivalent level, based on a usable value agreed together. The advertised value of software credits or volunteer hours is not counted as cash automatically.

AN IDEA, NOT YET A HACK876 AWARD

Microsoft AI for Good Award (proposed)

A suggestion only: an award for the build that best uses technology to solve a real problem for a Jamaican community. Teams could use any tools, and criteria would be agreed together.

11 A DIRECT LINE

There is no faceless sponsorship process here.

This proposal is for **Shane Patterson, Principal Technical Program Manager, Microsoft, and Executive Director, Project Blue Mountain.**[1]

If Microsoft is interested, we can decide together what involvement should actually look like.

QUESTIONS WE WOULD ANSWER TOGETHER

- ✓ How is this different from the Project Blue Mountain hackathon?
- ✓ What exactly would our contribution pay for, and where would Microsoft's name appear?
- ✓ Can students use Azure or Copilot on the day, given their ages?
- ✓ How do you keep judging fair when one judge works at Microsoft?
- ✓ How are students protected on consent, data and marketing?
- ✓ How much time would our mentors need to give?

A conversation, not a workload.

Deliberately focused.

Our vision is national. This inaugural staging does not have national-event resources, and we will not pretend it does.

Approximately 80 students. A school network of 9 in Kingston. One day, done properly.

Build the first one well.
Learn from it.
Earn the right to make the second one bigger.

2027

Help make the first Hack876 happen.

No multi-year commitment required.

FUTURE POSSIBILITIES, ONLY IF BOTH SIDES FIND IT VALUABLE. NOT COMMITMENTS.

- A recurring Microsoft award at every Hack876.
- Hack876 finalists invited to a future Tech Wave, if the Project Blue Mountain team would welcome them.
- A Microsoft mentor bench each year, growing as more alumni join.
- Support for network schools exploring Microsoft's education tools with their own IT teams.
- A pathway into Microsoft's university-level skills programmes once students leave school.



HACK876 × MICROSOFT

Somewhere in that room may be a future founder, engineer, designer or leader.

They do not need us to decide who they become.

They need an opportunity to begin.

HELP US BUILD THAT OPPORTUNITY.

We would love to explore the right first step with Shane, Yamile and the Microsoft team in Jamaica.

Kingston, Jamaica · Feb 20, 2027 (tentative)

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SOURCES

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5. Microsoft News Center, "MoEYI and Microsoft Jamaica target 155,000 persons for employability in new skills training agreement (July 30, 2021)." news.microsoft.com/es-xl/moeyi-and-microsoft-jamaica-target-155000-persons-for-employability-in-new-skills-training-agreement/

6. Microsoft On the Issues, "Microsoft Elevate: Putting people first, Brad Smith (July 9, 2025)." blogs.microsoft.com/on-the-issues/2025/07/09/elevate/

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A private partnership proposal prepared for Shane Patterson, Principal Technical Program Manager, Microsoft, and Executive Director, Project Blue Mountain, with Yamile Bustamante, Country Representative, Microsoft Jamaica.